

Azure Account Setup and Portal Familiarization

Student Name: Timothy Yakubu Osakede

Course: Cloud Computing

Date: 12 June 2026

Project Objective

The objective of this project was to create and configure a Microsoft Azure Free Tier account, explore the Azure Portal, create and manage resources, configure billing alerts, understand Azure security practices, and document the process with screenshots and explanations.

1. Account Creation Documentation

Azure Free Tier Signup Process

Step 1: Create a Microsoft Account

- Visited the Azure Free Account website.
- Signed in with a Microsoft account.

Step 2: Email Verification

- Entered an email address.
- Received a verification code.
- Confirmed ownership of the email account.

Step 3: Phone Verification

- Entered a mobile phone number.
- Received a One-Time Password (OTP).
- Entered the OTP to verify identity.

Step 4: Payment Card Verification

- Added a valid debit/credit card.
- Microsoft performed identity verification.
- No charges were made beyond the verification process.

Step 5: Account Activation

- Accepted Microsoft Azure terms and conditions.
- Successfully accessed the Azure Portal.
- Verified active subscription status.

Evidence: Screenshot showing active Azure subscription and account dashboard.

2. Azure Portal Navigation

Logging into Azure Portal

1. Opened portal.azure.com.
2. Entered Microsoft account credentials.
3. Completed authentication.
4. Accessed the Azure Home Dashboard.

Main Navigation Menu

The Azure Portal provides access to:

- Home
- Dashboard
- Resource Groups
- Virtual Machines
- Storage Accounts
- Cost Management + Billing
- Microsoft Entra ID
- Monitor

Search Functionality

The search bar at the top of the Azure Portal allows users to quickly find services, resources, settings, and documentation.

Breadcrumb Navigation

Azure uses breadcrumb navigation to help users understand their location within the portal and move between resources efficiently.

Evidence: Dashboard and Search screenshots.

3. Dashboard Customization

Objective

Customize the Azure dashboard to improve accessibility and resource visibility.

Steps Performed

1. Opened Dashboard.
2. Selected Edit Dashboard.
3. Added frequently used resource tiles.
4. Rearranged tiles into logical sections.
5. Saved the customized dashboard.

Tile Configuration

The following tiles were added:

- Resource Groups
- Storage Accounts
- Cost Management
- Microsoft Entra ID
- Recent Resources

This arrangement provides quick access to the most commonly used Azure services.

Evidence: Dashboard customization screenshot.

4. Governance Setup

Subscription Review

The active Azure subscription was reviewed to verify available credits and account status.

Resource Group Creation

Resource Group Name:

RG-Lab01

Region:

East US

Purpose:

To logically organize deployed resources.

Evidence: Subscription and Resource Group screenshots.

5. Resource Deployment

Storage Account Deployment

Resource Type:
Storage Account

Region:
East US

Performance:
Standard

Redundancy:
Locally Redundant Storage (LRS)

Deployment Steps

1. Opened Storage Accounts.
2. Selected Create.
3. Entered required resource information.
4. Validated configuration settings.
5. Completed deployment.

Evidence: Storage Account deployment screenshot.

6. Billing and Cost Management

Navigation

1. Opened Cost Management + Billing from the Azure Portal.
2. Accessed Cost Analysis.
3. Reviewed current usage and available credits.
4. Monitored subscription spending.

Budget Alert Configuration

Budget Name:
FreeTierBudget

Budget Amount:
\$1.00

Alert Threshold:
45%

Notification Method:
Email Alert

Configuration Steps

1. Opened Cost Management.
2. Selected Budgets.
3. Created a new budget.
4. Entered budget amount.
5. Configured a 75% alert threshold.
6. Added email notification.
7. Saved the budget.

Evidence: Budget alert screenshot.

7. Free Tier Limits and Summary

Azure Free Account Benefits

Initial Credit

- \$200 USD credit available for the first 30 days.

1-Month Free Services

Service	Free Tier Allocation
Virtual Machines	Selected B-Series usage
Blob Storage	5 GB LRS Storage
Azure Files	Limited free quota
SQL Database	Limited monthly allocation
Bandwidth	Limited outbound data transfer

Always-Free Services

- Azure Functions
- Event Grid
- Azure Advisor
- Azure DevTest Labs

These limits help users learn Azure while controlling costs.

8. Security Considerations

Password Policy

- Use strong passwords.
- Include uppercase, lowercase, numbers, and symbols.
- Avoid password reuse.

Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)

MFA Setup Process

1. Open Microsoft Entra ID.
2. Select Users.
3. Open Authentication Methods.
4. Enable Multi-Factor Authentication.
5. Register Microsoft Authenticator.
6. Complete verification.

Security Best Practices

- Enable MFA on all accounts.
- Follow least-privilege access principles.
- Review user permissions regularly.
- Monitor sign-in activity.
- Keep recovery information updated.
- Review Azure security recommendations.